



Word Jobs: Nouns, Verbs, Adjectives, and Adverbs

Grade 3 • Maryland • Grammar

L1.a (Grade 3)

Explain how nouns, pronouns, verbs, adjectives, and adverbs function in sentences. Includes 16 practice tasks, a four-task exit check, two explained models, and complete answer guidance.

PRINT • TEACH • REVISIT



Plan a focused lesson

Level and alignment

Grade 3 • Maryland • Grammar; L1.a (Grade 3). Focus: Explain how nouns, pronouns, verbs, adjectives, and adverbs function in sentences.

What is included

One cover; one teacher guide; one mini-lesson with two explained models; 1 original text/reference section(s); 16 practice tasks on four pages; one four-task exit check; four answer-key pages covering all 20 tasks; two access/source/license pages. Student texts are original, not extracted from released tests.

Time and sequence

Two 30–40-minute sessions plus a 10–15-minute exit check; extended writing or speech rehearsal may take longer. Model first; use tasks 1–4 to check readiness; practice the remainder in short groups; give tasks 17–20 without the key.

Preparation

Print student pages separately from teacher pages. Provide pencils and extra paper; oral-response learners need an adult recorder. Review word meanings and prerequisite decoding or sentence skills. No paid app, novel, or external reading is required.

Student directions

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.



Learn the move

A word's job depends on its sentence. A noun names; a pronoun can replace a noun; a verb expresses an action or state; an adjective describes a noun; an adverb can describe how an action happens. Ask what the word does here, not just what ending it has. This packet uses clear examples, not all possible word jobs.

Model 1 • In “The small bird sings softly,” explain small and softly.

Small describes bird, so it is an adjective. Softly describes how the bird sings, so it is an adverb.

Model 2 • In “Lena smiles. She waves,” what does she do?

She is a pronoun standing for Lena, avoiding repetition of the name.

Try the task first. Then compare the reasoning, not just the final word.



Word-job reference

Noun: garden, dancer, hope. Pronoun: he, she, it, they. Verb: hops, is, became.
Adjective: narrow, bright, patient. Adverb: slowly, carefully, often. Not every adverb ends in ly, and not every ly word is an adverb. Use the sentence to explain the relationship.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

1. In “The rabbit hops,” name the noun.

2. In “The rabbit hops,” name the verb.

3. What does blue do in “A blue kite rises”?

4. What does gently do in “Rain falls gently”?



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

5. Replace Nora in the second sentence: Nora reads. Nora laughs.

6. Replace the boxes: The boxes are heavy. The boxes need a cart.

7. Explain quiet in “The quiet room has a rug.”

8. Explain quietly in “We enter quietly.”



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

9. Add an adjective: The ___ path bends. Explain its job.

10. Add an adverb: The turtle moves ___. Explain its job.

11. In “They build a tall tower,” identify they and tower.

12. In “The sky is gray,” is is a verb even without movement?



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

13. Explain light in “The light bag lifts easily.”

14. Explain light in “The light shines.”

15. Write a sentence with a noun and an action verb. Label each.

16. Add an adjective and an adverb to that sentence.



Exit check • Apply the skill

Try without the answer key. Show evidence or reasoning when asked. Use separate paper for longer responses.

17. In “He carries a red box carefully,” name the pronoun and noun.

18. Name the verb in that sentence.

19. Explain red and carefully in that sentence.

20. Change carefully to quickly. What changes?



Answers and response criteria

1. rabbit names the animal.
2. hops tells the action.
3. Describes kite; adjective.
4. Describes how rain falls; adverb.
5. Nora reads. She laughs. She replaces Nora.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

6. They need a cart. They refers to the boxes.
7. Adjective describing room.
8. Adverb describing how we enter.
9. Example: narrow; describes path. Accept an appropriate adjective.
10. Example: slowly; describes moves.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

11. They is a pronoun; tower is a noun naming a thing.
12. Yes. Is expresses a state/link between sky and gray.
13. Adjective describing bag as not heavy.
14. Noun naming a source of illumination; job differs from item 13.
15. Example: Birds [noun] glide [verb]. Labels must match actual use.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

16. Example: Small birds glide smoothly. Small describes birds; smoothly describes glide.

17. He is the pronoun; box is the noun.

18. carries.

19. Red describes box, adjective; carefully describes carries, adverb.

20. The manner of carrying changes from taking care to moving fast; the carrier and box remain the same.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Access and next teaching steps

AIG

Ask for a counterexample, an alternative supported interpretation, or a newly written item with an explanation. Add depth rather than speed.

504

Follow the individual plan: breaks, enlarged print, extra time, reduced copying, or an alternative response method as documented. These are classroom options, not a statement of permitted test accommodations.

EC

Follow the IEP; show one task at a time, model the first decision, and permit dictated reasoning when appropriate. For decoding practice, distinguish an adult-read direction from an adult-read target word.

ESL

Preview task verbs and key vocabulary, allow home-language planning, and offer “My answer is ___ because ___.” Evaluate the targeted skill separately from unrelated language errors. For French, retain the target French sentence while explaining directions in a familiar language.

Use the exit evidence

For each exit task, record 2 = accurate and complete for the stated prompt; 1 = partly accurate or missing a requested explanation; 0 = not yet demonstrated. Total 0–8 is a local teaching note, not a standardized score. For oral tasks do not penalize spelling or handwriting. Revisit the exact type of error rather than assigning a diagnostic label.

Next lesson: model one missed decision, let the learner try a new example, and compare the explanation. Extend only after the learner can explain the targeted skill.

Alignment, sources, and license

The objective is original wording describing a focused part of the cited standard; this is not a full curriculum or official practice test. The revised Grade 3 Language document labels this skill L1.a; the grade is supplied separately, as in the source.

Official state standard • accessed September 15, 2026

<https://marylandpublicschools.org/programs/Documents/ELA/revised-standards/Grade-Levels/Grade-3-Language-A.pdf>

Research limit: official released-assessment retrieval was unsuccessful in this run. This packet is standards-focused classroom instruction; it makes no released-test alignment, timing, or scoring claim.

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